LANDSKNECHT ARMS

As always in the history of warfare, status was an important consideration in the weapons and armour of a Landsknecht. To own body armour or a two-handed sword was to be a man of considerable standing. The halberd, however, had intermediate status, and became a symbolic attribute of junior officers. The pike was most basic of all, but without it a man could not become a Landsknecht. Firearms generally had low status as the soldiers who fired them did not fight in close combat.

Pike
Between 4 and 5m (14 and 18ft) long, the pike was the principal weapon of the Landsknecht. The steel head was mounted on a shaft of ash.

Crested skull

BURGONET

Spike

Halberd
Developed by the Swiss in the 13th century, the halberd was chiefly a slashing weapon, although its spike could be used for thrusting. This Landsknecht version dates from 1500.

Peak

Long blade

Fluke

Open face

Cheek guard

Breastplate

Socket

Rounded pommel

Langet (steel frame) protects shaft

Langet pin

Leather-bound double-handed grip

Laft pauldron (shoulder guard)

Doppelhänder
This enormous, blunt-ended, double-handed sword was designed for hacking through enemy pike formations. It was also used for executions.

Fore sight

Barrel takes a Five-bore round

Fore stock